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OVER 23,000 IFTAR MEALS DISTRIBUTED IN AL AIN

In a remarkable display of community spirit, the Emirates Red Crescent (ERC), in partnership with the Fatima Bint Mubarak Ladies Sports Academy (FBMA), organised a large-scale initiative to distribute more than 23,000 iftar meals at Hazza Bin Zayed Stadium in Al Ain. Held under the patronage of Shaikha Fatima Bint Hazza Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Chairwoman of FBMA, the event, themed 'Bring Your Iftar to Us', brought together more than 28,000 attendees, including UAE University students and representatives from local institutions, communities, and companies.

SEE ALSO P4

Israel threatens to annex parts of Gaza over hostages

HAMAS WARNS CAPTIVES WOULD RETURN 'IN COFFINS'

TEL AVIV

Israel Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu threatened yesterday to seize parts of Gaza if Hamas does not release hostages, while the militant group warned they would return "in coffins" if Israel does not stop bombing the Palestinian territory.

Just over a week since the military resumed operations following a January truce, Israel said two projectiles were fired from the Gaza Strip, with one intercepted and the other landing near the border, and with no immediate reports of any casualties or damage.

The rocket fire came a day after hundreds of Palestinians staged a rare protest against Hamas, chanting slogans against the Islamist movement and calling for an end to the war.

According to the health ministry in Hamas-run Gaza,

According to the health ministry in Hamas-run Gaza, 830 people have been killed in the territory since Israel resumed its strikes on March 18.

830 people have been killed in the territory since Israel resumed its strikes on March 18. No deaths have been reported on the Israeli side.

Israeli officials say the resumption of operations was meant to pressure Hamas into releasing the remaining hostages, after a stalemate in talks with mediators on extending the truce — which saw 33 Israeli captives freed in exchange for Palestinian prisoners.

Netanyahu told parliament that "the more Hamas persists in its refusal to release our hostages, the stronger the pressure we will exert".

"This includes the seizure of territories, along with other measures I will not elaborate here," he added, days after his Defence Minister Israel Katz had warned: "The more Hamas refuses to free the hostages, the more territory it will lose, which will be annexed by Israel".

58 hostages still held

Of the 251 hostages seized during Hamas's October 7, 2023 attack on Israel which triggered the war, 58 are still held in Gaza, including 34 the Israeli military says are dead.

"Every time the occupation attempts to retrieve its captives by force, it ends up bringing them back in coffins," Hamas said in a statement.

The group said it was "doing everything possible to keep the (Israeli) occupation's captives alive, but the random Zionist bombardment is endangering their lives".

— AFP



SPORT

UAE head coach Paulo Bento and his staff dismissed

Decision comes hours after UAE's 2-1 victory | P14

1.33b pounds of Coke plastic to enter waterways by 2030

Amount can fill stomachs of 18m whales

WASHINGTON

By 2030, Coca-Cola products will account for an estimated 1.33 billion pounds (602,000 metric tonnes) of plastic waste entering the world's oceans and waterways each year, according to a stark new analysis published yesterday by the non-profit Oceana. That's enough plastic to fill the stomachs of 18 million whales.

The report arrives amid mounting concerns over the human health risks posed by the spread of microplastics, which scientists increasingly link



to cancer, infertility, heart disease, and more.

Coca-Cola ranks as the world's top branded plastic polluter, followed by PepsiCo, Nestle, Danone, and Altria, according to Science Advances. Coca-Cola's plastic use is projected to exceed 4.13 billion metric tonnes (9.12 billion pounds) annually by 2030. — AFP

Running red lights main cause of accidents in UAE

271 incidents due to jumping stop signal; 67 mishaps by drivers with invalid licence

ABU DHABI

BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

As per the UAE Traffic Law, motorists who jump a red light face a fine of Dh1,000, 12 black points, and the vehicle being impounded for 30 days.

And yet, jumping the red light was the main cause of accidents in the UAE in 2024, according to the latest statistics released by the Ministry of Interior.

The red light violation resulted in 271 incidents nationwide, with Abu Dhabi recording the highest number of incidents at 153, followed by 111 in Dubai, three each in Ras Al Khaimah and Umm Al Quwain, and one in Sharjah.

Highest in Abu Dhabi

The report also revealed that 67 accidents involved individuals who did not hold a valid driving licence. Abu Dhabi had the highest number with 55 cases, while Sharjah recorded seven, Umm Al Quwain three, and Fujairah two. Other emir-

223

accidents due to drivers merging into main roads incorrectly

ates did not report any such incidents.

Failure to give way was also found to be a common mistake. A major factor in accidents was drivers merging onto main roads without ensuring they were clear. A total of 223 accidents occurred due to this mistake. Of them, 129 occurred in Abu Dhabi, 33 in Fujairah, 26 in Ras Al Khaimah, 19 in Sharjah, 12 in Umm Al Quwain and four in Ajman.

Mechanical failures and tire blowouts were also seen to be on the rise. Abu Dhabi witnessed 26 accidents due to tire explosions, Dubai eight and Ras Al Khaimah three.

Driving in the wrong direction caused 16 accidents in Abu Dhabi and two in Fujairah.

Failing to give way to pedestrians led to 96 accidents last year. Abu Dhabi recorded the highest number with 37 incidents, followed by Dubai 34, Ras Al Khaimah eight, Fujairah 15 and Sharjah two.

SEE ALSO P2

TECH

UAE embraces the challenge of space technology amid global race | P8

INDIA

Supreme Court stays HC's observations on attempt to rape | P12



IFTAR 18:36

Fajr	04:58	Shuruq	06:12
Dhuhr	12:27	Asr	15:53
Maghrib	18:36	Isha	19:51

IMSAK 04:48

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

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